

Prerequisites

Before working through any of these guides, get the following installed and configured. None of it is Phidgets-specific code — it's the plumbing that lets your computer talk to the hardware and lets you comfortably write and run the examples.

1. A code editor — VS Code

Any text editor can open a `.html` file, but [Visual Studio Code](#) is the recommended editor for these guides. It's free, has great built-in support for HTML/JavaScript, and its integrated terminal makes running the later Node-based examples straightforward.

Download and install it from code.visualstudio.com. No extra extensions are required to get started.

2. A browser — Chrome

These guides open `.html` files directly in a browser and rely on the browser's developer console for debugging. [Google Chrome](#) is recommended — its DevTools (accessed with `F12` or `Ctrl+Shift+I`) are what we'll reference when talking about the console.

Any modern browser will technically run the examples, but if something looks different than what a guide describes, try Chrome before troubleshooting further.

3. The Phidget hardware and drivers

Before your computer can see any Phidget device, you need the Phidgets drivers installed. Pick the guide for your OS:

- **Windows:** [Phidgets Downloads for Windows](#)
- **macOS:** [Phidgets Downloads for macOS](#)
- **Linux:** [Phidgets Downloads for Linux](#)

1. Follow your OS's page above and download the latest **Phidget22 installer** (Linux installs via a script instead of a graphical installer — the page walks through it).
2. Run the installer. This installs the low-level drivers your OS needs to recognize a Phidget hub or device when it's plugged in over USB.
3. Plug in your Phidget hub (VINT hub, or similar) and confirm it's recognized — on Windows, check Device Manager for any "unknown device" warnings; on macOS and Linux, the OS-specific page above shows how to verify the device is seen.

4. The Phidget Network Server

These guides connect to Phidgets over the network (via `NetworkConnection`) rather than talking to USB directly from the browser. That requires the **Phidget Network Server** to be installed and running on the machine the hardware is plugged into.

Installing the server

The Phidget Network Server is included as part of the Phidget22 installer from the step above, on all three operating systems.

Starting the server

Windows

1. Open the **Phidget Control Panel** (installed alongside the drivers) from the Start menu.
2. Find the **Network Server** section and make sure it's toggled **on**. It defaults to listening on port `8989` .
3. You should see a Phidget22 icon appear in the Windows system tray, indicating the server is running.

Once running, the server stays active in the background — you don't need to relaunch it every time, only confirm it's still running (check the system tray icon) before starting an example.

macOS

1. Open the **Phidget Control Panel** app (installed alongside the drivers).
2. Find the **Network Server** section and toggle it **on**. It defaults to listening on port `8989` .
3. A Phidget22 icon should appear in the menu bar, indicating the server is running.

Linux

Linux doesn't have a graphical Control Panel by default — the Network Server runs as a service instead.

1. Follow the [Phidgets Downloads for Linux](#) page to install `phidget22networkserver` .
2. Start (and enable, so it survives reboots) the service:

```
sudo systemctl enable --now phidget22networkserver
```

3. Confirm it's running with:

```
sudo systemctl status phidget22networkserver
```

It defaults to listening on port `8989` , same as Windows and macOS.

Once running on any OS, the server stays active in the background — you don't need to relaunch it every time, only confirm it's still running before starting an example.

Confirming it's working

With the server running and a device plugged in, open the Phidget Control Panel again — it should list your attached device(s) under its own view. If your device shows up there, the examples in this repo will be able to see it too, using `localhost` and port `8989` as the connection address.

5. Node.js (only needed for Example 4)

Examples 1 through 3 are single `.html` files — no installation beyond the above is required to run them.

[4 SPA.md](#) and its framework examples (`4a_Vue` , `4b_React` , `4c_Angular`), however, use build tools that require [Node.js](#).

1. Download and install the **LTS** version from [nodejs.org](#).
2. Confirm it installed correctly by opening a terminal (VS Code's integrated terminal works fine) and running:

```
node --version
npm --version
```

Both should print a version number rather than an error.

You won't need to touch Node directly — each framework example's own README will walk you through `npm install` and starting its dev server.

You're ready

At this point you should have:

- VS Code installed, for editing the example files.
- Chrome installed, for running the examples and reading console output.
- Phidget22 drivers installed, with your hardware recognized by Windows.
- The Phidget Network Server running, listening on `localhost:8989` .
- Node.js installed, if you plan to work through Example 4's framework versions.

From here, move on to [1 DigitalInput.md](#) .